

PROJECT LINK: <https://github.com/jereguerin/INST462-Project-3>

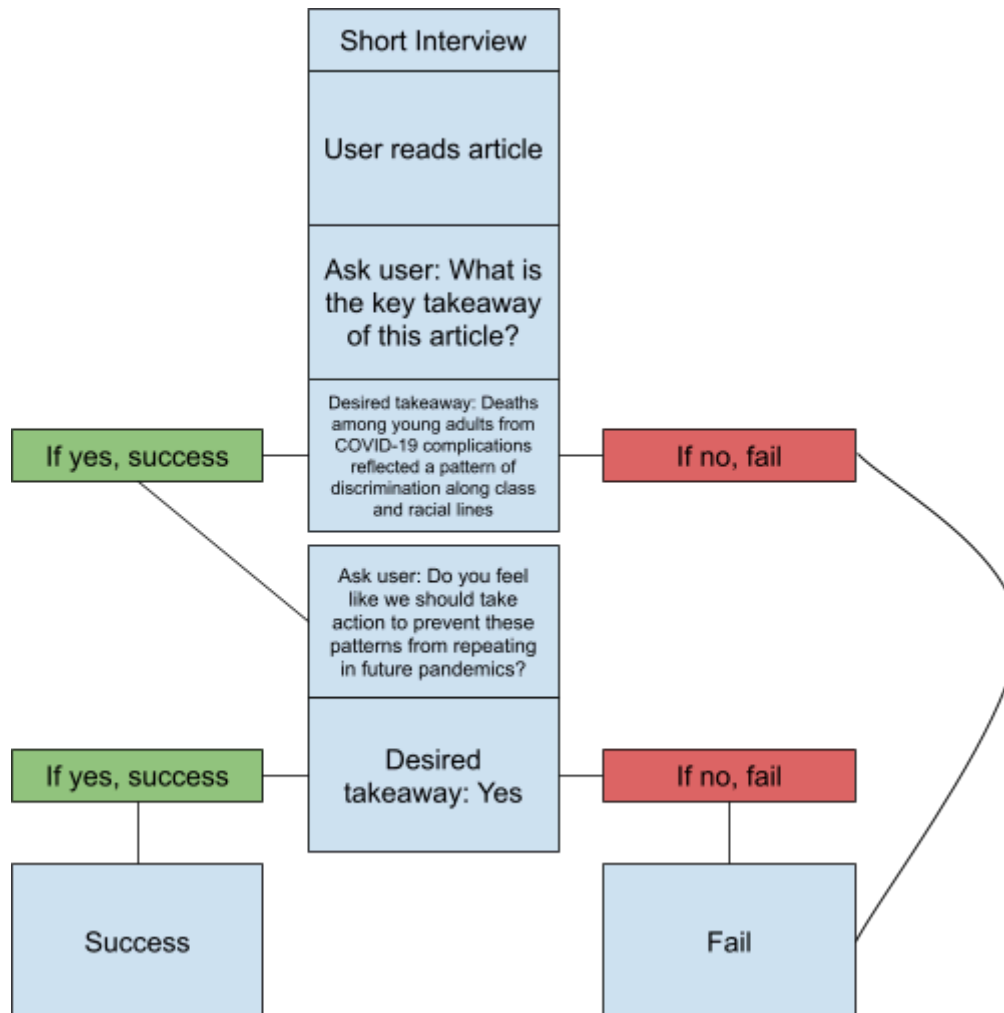
My project is a story about how COVID-19 deaths among young adults 18-34 is part of a larger cycle of poverty and racial discrimination. Through my article, users will learn how their own state reflected these patterns and will learn how they compare to the two states that had it the worst, New Mexico and Mississippi. The main takeaway users will learn from is that the long-standing issue of racial and class discrimination in healthcare made the COVID-19 pandemic far worse in impoverished and minority communities, allowing even young adults who were supposed to survive, to perish.

The article begins with an introduction to the topic. Users are asked to enter the state they live in. The article then shapes itself around the user's respective state, comparing their state to New Mexico and Mississippi's rate of young adult deaths from COVID-19. There are two maps in the article, one depicting young adult deaths in each state and one depicting the racial disparity in young adult deaths, and users have the option to choose between the map and a ranked list. These features allow the user to see how their state compares to the worst offenders in terms of young adult deaths from COVID-19 and learn about how these patterns that manifested in New Mexico and Mississippi might have been potentially (depending on the user's state) repeated in their community. I designed my experience this way because I wanted to create a piece of journalism that users don't just read, but experience. I want them to walk away more aware of these patterns of discrimination and I think that the best way of accomplishing that is to have users actually experience it from the perspective of where they live.

Overall, I feel like gathering the data and planning the structure of the article was the easiest. When I found the datasets on the CDC website, I knew I had a treasure trove of opportunities to create an interesting story. I knew right off the bat I wanted to focus on young adults, but once I saw the statistics on young adult deaths from COVID-19 I realized I had a very interesting and hardly covered topic that might be good to cover. Creating the article was fairly straight forward for the most part as well, as I simply gathered the datasets, had Claude write a prototype, and then tweaked it.

The most challenging thing was probably adding more interaction beyond just entering your state. I really didn't know where to go beyond that initially without risking derailing the entire focus of the story. So I decided to expand the user's options when it came to how they perceived the data by adding more infoboxes and visuals about the user's state as well as expanding interactivity and accessibility by adding a ranked list toggle on each map in the article. This allowed the user to have more opportunity to interact with the article without sacrificing the narrative. Claude also proved to be disobedient at times, making bizarre decisions such as fabricating quotes and citing the dataset as the source of said quote, as if the dataset opened its mouth and spoke to Claude personally. With more time, I'd probably try to interview two people from these states that live in communities that suffered the most who knew young adults who died from COVID-19 complications and frame the story as a narrative about these people and their experience, comparing their experiences in their state to the user's state.

Evaluation Plan



Appendix: Claude Prompts

Sonnet 4.6 (Adaptive)

“Generate me an editorial about COVID-19 deaths among young adults. It will be a news story that basically builds itself from user input. It will start with an intro to how many young adults aged 18-34 are dying from COVID-19, which you can source from stats1.xls. The user then selects the state they live in from a drop down menu, where it then tells the user how many young adults in their respective state died from COVID-19. After this, the rest of the article opens up and discusses how New Mexico was the state with the highest number of COVID-19 deaths among young adults. The rate of deaths among young adults in the user’s selected state will then be compared to New Mexico’s rate of deaths. You can source this information from stats1.xls. The article will then go on to also discuss Mississippi and how it saw the second highest rate of deaths, and compare that to the user’s state, which you can also source from stats1.xls. After this, the article will then discuss poverty and how that often results in poor health outcomes that contributed to young adults dying from COVID-19 in New Mexico and Mississippi, displaying the user’s state’s poverty level and comparing it to Mississippi and New Mexico’s respectively, data you can source from poverty.csv. After this, there will be another section about how racial minorities were often overrepresented in COVID-19 deaths among young adults in Mississippi and New Mexico, and subsequently telling the user about the rate of deaths from COVID-19 among racial minorities in their respective state compared to that of white people, which you can source from minorities.xls and whites.xls. The article will then conclude with a conclusion paragraph. Use the attached datasets for this article and if you need more data inform me so I can also attach it. Be sure to use graphs, maps, and other visuals throughout”

“I need you to do the following: First off, use the attached “ReworkedArticle” file to rewrite the article, as I need this to be my own writing. and this is my own writing Next, at the “your state, your story” section, include a note that statistics for Vermont are suppressed and thus unavailable. Then, at the “top ten states” chart, make Mississippi’s bar the same shade as New Mexico (red). Do the same for the “death rate comparison: your state, New Mexico, and Mississippi” chart, as well as the “family poverty rate” chart. Also, remove the box with the sentence “The pandemic didn’t create these disparities. It revealed them — and then it punished the people who were already being punished,” as this is not an actual quote and I don’t know what you were thinking here.”

“First off, the title is supposed to be The “Young Who Didn’t Make It,” and the subheader below it is supposed to say “They said COVID-19 would spare the young, but for thousands of Americans between 18 and 34, it never did.” Also, replace the paragraph “Mississippi’s rate, like New Mexico’s, cannot be understood in isolation. It is the product of decades of underinvestment in healthcare, high poverty rates, and a racial makeup that left communities of color particularly exposed to a virus that would exploit every existing inequality” with “New Mexico and Mississippi were not mere anomalies, but a result of decades of underinvestment in healthcare, high poverty rates, and a history of racial discrimination that left young people of color particularly vulnerable.””

"You absolute degenerate. Why did you repeat the paragraph "New Mexico and Mississippi were not mere anomalies, but a result of decades of underinvestment in healthcare, high poverty rates, and a history of racial discrimination that left young people of color particularly vulnerable."??? Delete that paragraph between the map and the top ten states chart."

"Ok, first off, remove the three boxes below the paragraph that says "New Mexico and Mississippi are two of the poorest states in the nation by family poverty rate, with Mississippi leading all 50 states at a rate of 14.3% of families living below the poverty line. New Mexico, ranking 49th nationally, trails just behind at 13.7%. The national average across all 50 states is 8.7%," as the chart below already communicates that. Instead, replace it with an infobox comparing the user's state to New Mexico and Mississippi similar to what you did with the your state vs Mississippi and your state vs New Mexico infoboxes. Next, below the paragraph that says "Systemic racism in healthcare made the COVID-19 Pandemic much more dangerous for minority communities in New Mexico and Mississippi. Racial minorities in the United States are often residentially segregated in areas with less access to healthcare and are overrepresented in front-line roles considered essential with little opportunity to socially distance. Consequently, the Pandemic was yet another chapter in America's history of discrimination," remove the two boxes comparing the racial disparity in COVID deaths as the bar chart below it also communicates the same thing. Instead, replace it with an infobox comparing the user's state to New Mexico and Mississippi similar to what you did with the your state vs Mississippi and your state vs New Mexico infoboxes. Then, below the paragraph that says "The disparities within your own state tell a local story of this wider nationwide saga. Whether or not your state's minority-to-white death ratio mirrors the national rate or exceeds it, the loss of life that occurred as a result of this disparity could have been easily mended with more equitable access to healthcare and housing, and better working conditions," add a map showing the racial disparity rate in COVID deaths among young adults. As for interactive features, on the "COVID-19 Death Rate Among Young Adults (18–34) by State" map, add a toggle so users can select between a map and a ranked list, with the user's state in bold."

"Could you add a ranked list feature to the racial disparity map? Also, could you make it so that it says the article was written by Jeremy Guerin"

"One last request. I need you to take the "Top 10 States: COVID-19 Death Rate, Young Adults (18–34)" chart and turn it into a tab in the "COVID-19 Death Rate Among Young Adults (18–34) by State" where you can scroll and see each state rather than just the top ten (be sure to color the user's state in orange). Also in the ranked list for that visualization, remove that weird grey bar thats sitting there next to the number as it's being unused. Then, take the racial disparity map and ranked list and move it right below the "Minority vs. White COVID-19 Death Rates, Young Adults (18–34)" box. Also, make the date say "Published May 8, 2026" rather than "Published April 28, 2026". Finally, could you include a link to this github page containing all the datasets at the very bottom of the page under the sources section:

<https://github.com/jereguerin/INST462-Project-3.git>"

“Now remove the weird grey bar beside each number from the ranked list in the "Racial Disparity in COVID-19 Deaths Among Young Adults, by State" box and replace the final two paragraphs in the black box at the bottom titled "A Failure We Must Not Repeat" with "The story of COVID-19 deaths among young adults in the United States is a story two pandemics happening simultaneously; among America's middle and upper class, it was a story of social distancing, school shutdowns, and remote work. But for impoverished and minority communities in states like New Mexico and Mississippi, many of the opportunities to practice social distancing were absent, and health inequality allowed the virus to target even the young despite popular health authorities insisting they would be spared. Should America allow this injustice to continue, more young adults in these communities will perish in the next pandemic.”"